

Silvia Téliz

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Summary

I am a PhD candidate (expected July 2027) at the Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania, studying visual political communication and social biases in multimodal AI systems. I combine computer vision, natural language processing, and machine learning to analyze large-scale multimodal data, from TikTok content, to street political advertisements. My dissertation project, *Visual Cues as Political Communication: A Computational Look into Mexican Federal Electoral Campaigns*, examines how skin tone and other visual cues influence electoral outcomes in Mexico. I have also conducted research on the nature of social biases in large language models and vision-language models. My work has been published in the *International Journal of Press/Politics* and presented at conferences such as IC2S2 and PolNet-PACSS. I have extensive experience in teaching and mentoring students, having served as a teaching fellow for two courses at the Annenberg School for Communication, and as an instructor of record at Universidad Panamericana.

Education

PhD in Communication, Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania	2027
<i>Degree expected in July 2027. Dissertation title: 'Visual Cues as Political Communication: A Computational Look into Mexican Federal Electoral Campaigns'. Committee: Dr. Sandra González-Bailón (chair), Dr. Deen Freelon, Dr. Yphtach Lelkes.</i>	
Master of Arts in Communication, Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania	2024
Bachelor of Arts in Communication, Universidad Panamericana (Mexico City, Mexico)	2018

Publications

Skin Tone as a Visual Cue in Political Campaigns: Evidence from Elections in Mexico	2026
Silvia Téliz, Sandra González-Bailón 10.1177/19401612261484045 (<i>International Journal of Press/Politics</i>)	
WhichTok? Comparing Three TikTok Data Acquisition Tools	2026
Gayoung Jeon, Cameron Moy, Silvia Téliz , Cristina Monzer, Nicolette Alayon, Deen Freelon arxiv.org/abs/2608.09917 (arXiv preprint, accepted for the upcoming 21st International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media)	
Poder Prieto: Media, Colorism, and Cultural Activism in Mexico	2026
Juan Llamas-Rodríguez, Silvia Téliz nyupress.org/9781479835164/planet-digital (Planet Digital, NYU Press)	
Agresiones a periodistas y cobertura mediática de la corrupción [Attacks on Journalists and Media Coverage of Corruption]	2021
Georgina Flores-Ivich, Silvia Téliz 10.2307/j.ctv1jhvn9w (Crisis de estatalidad y violaciones a derechos humanos, FLACSO México)	

Research Experience

Research Fellow , Politics, Identities, and Communication Lab – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania	May 2025 – present
- Secured \$10,000 USD via the Annenberg School for Communication Internal Grant for the project 'Identifying Biases in VLMs' Zero-Shot Classifications of Race and Gender' (2026-2027 academic year), as lead researcher. - Collaborated on the theoretical conceptualization, formulation of overarching research goals, methodology design, computational analysis of text and image data, writing, reviewing, and editing for projects developed within the lab under Dr. Deen Freelon's supervision.	

Research Experience (continued)

Research Fellow, Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

- Collaborated with Dr. Juan Llamas Rodríguez on the development of a mixed-methods study on the representation of gender and skin color stereotypes in Mexican telenovelas and TV series (a report commissioned by the Luminate foundation).

Research Assistant, Facultad Latinoamericana de Ciencias Sociales (FLACSO) – Mexico City, Mexico 2018 – 2022

- Coordinated a research consulting project to identify the strengths and weaknesses of the evaluation system of information transparency for the National Institute of Access to Information and Personal Data Protection.
- Developed an academic program and created didactic content for the National School for Women of the Institutional Revolutionary Party, empowering female members through education on gender perspective, political representation, and communication strategies.
- Created educational content for the Migrant-e project (led by the Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México), teaching undocumented immigrants in the United States about their rights and safety tools.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Fellow, Introduction to Communication Behavior – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Taught lecture ‘Media Effects on Community and Everyday Culture’.
- Taught recitation section, providing students with additional support and guidance on course materials.
- Tutored students on how to improve their studying strategies and reading comprehension skills for weekly exams. Provided guidance on the development of a research plan for their final projects.

Teaching Fellow, Children and Media – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Taught lecture ‘Racial Representations in Children’s Media’.
- Clarified students’ doubts and provided additional support on course materials during dedicated office hours.

Instructor of Record, Quantitative Methods for Communication Research – Universidad Panamericana, Mexico City Jan 2020 – Dec 2022

- Taught introductory course on quantitative research methods for students in the Communication major.
- Introduced R into the curriculum as the main tool for learning Quantitative Methods.
- Guided students through in-class exercises, which included statistical analysis, data visualization, and interpretation of results using R.
- Designed original educational materials, including slides, assignments, tests, and lab activities.

Presentations

Understanding Bias in AI Systems September 2026
Silvia Téliz

Guest lecture. COM 107 AI and Creativity, Stony Brook University - Stony Brook, NY, USA (classroom size: 400)

Mechanisms of Social Bias in Large Language Models: Disentangling Linguistic Framing from Group Specification July 2026

Vishwanath Emani Venkata, Silvia Téliz

Conference presentation. IC2S2 conference - Burlington, VT, USA

Picturing Immigration: A Multimodal Computational Analysis of the 2024 U.S. Presidential Campaign August 2025

Silvia Téliz, Gayoung Jeon

Poster presentation. PolNet-PACSS conference - Boston, MA, USA

A Picture is Worth a Thousand Fictions: Visual Political Communication in the Age of Generative AI April 2025

Silvia Téliz

Invited talk. CIND Workshop 2025 - Philadelphia, PA, USA

Presentations (continued)

- Hues of Victory: Using Computer Vision to Examine Skin Color's Influence on Electoral Success** June 2024
Silvia Téliz
Conference presentation. ICA Preconference: "A Computational Turn in Journalism: Opportunities and Challenges in a Cross-Disciplinary Field" - Singapore
- Status, Color and Race: Dissecting the content of Latin American class stereotypes** May 2023
Valentina Proust Iligaray, Silvia Téliz
Conference presentation. ICA Preconference: "Media and Communication in Global Latinidades" - Online

Technical Skills and Methodologies

Methods: Computational visual analysis, natural language processing, machine learning, social media data collection, survey and experiment design, content analysis

Programming: Python, R, Git, HTML, CSS

Software: Gephi, Adobe Illustrator, GitHub, Stata

AI Tools and Deployment: Hugging Face Transformers, Ollama, OpenRouter, proprietary LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI, Gemini), PyTorch

Languages: Spanish: native speaker, English: advanced (C2), French: intermediate (B2), German: intermediate (B1)

Honors and Awards

- Annenberg School for Communication Internal Grant** 2026
\$10,000 USD, lead researcher, for the project 'Identifying Biases in VLMs' Zero-Shot Classifications of Race and Gender' (2026-2027 academic year).
- Graduate Scholarship in Sciences and Humanities** 2025
Awarded by the Ministry of Science, Humanities, Technology and Innovation of Mexico (SECIHTI)
- Fulbright García-Robles Scholarship** 2022
Awarded by the US-Mexico Foundation (COMEXUS)

Certificates

- Summer Institute in Computational Social Science** 2026
Awarded by the University of Pennsylvania
- Certificate in College and University Teaching** 2025
Awarded by the University of Pennsylvania

Scholarly Memberships and Service

- Center for Information Networks and Democracy – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania** 2023 – 2026
Doctoral fellow and meeting administrator
- Coordinated room and catering logistics for weekly meetings.
 - Contacted speakers for weekly meetings.
 - Managed communications with center members.
- Center for Advanced Research in Global Communication – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania** 2022 – 2025
Doctoral fellow
- Participated in center seminars.
 - Coordinated IT and speaker logistics for the 2025 CARGC Fellows Biennial Conference.
- Graduate Student Council – Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania** 2023 – 2024

Scholarly Memberships and Service (continued)

Member and information manager

- Organized networking and social events for graduate students.
- Communicated student grievances to faculty and administrators.
- Organized town hall meetings for graduate students.
- Kept weekly meeting agendas.